

FREE BONUS GUIDE

10 Sauces That Make Your Canned Meat Unforgettable

From jar to table in 25 minutes or less — no experience needed

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WHAT YOU WILL FIND INSIDE

→ **10 beginner-friendly sauce recipes** — all under 25 minutes

→ Each sauce **paired with specific recipes** from your cookbook

→ **Pro tips** to avoid the most common beginner mistakes

→ **Serving suggestions** that turn a jar into a complete dinner

→ No special equipment. **No hard-to-find ingredients**.

The jars on your shelf are already good. These sauces make them great.

Before You Start

The canned meats in your cookbook are already seasoned, cooked, and shelf-stable for up to 18 months. Opening a jar and heating it gives you a solid, satisfying meal. Adding one of these sauces turns that meal into something worth repeating.

Every sauce in this guide is designed for beginners — short ingredient lists, no fancy equipment, and clear instructions that explain not just what to do but why. Each one has been paired with specific recipes from your cookbook so you always know where to start.

⚠ Important safety note

These sauces are finishing sauces. Make them only after opening and heating your canned meat.
Do not add these sauces to jars before pressure canning.

A few things to keep in mind before you begin:

- Read the full recipe before you start — the pro tip often contains information that affects the whole process.
- Taste as you go. Salt, acid, and heat levels are personal — these recipes are starting points.
- Use the broth from your canned meat jars wherever it is called for. It is already seasoned and adds depth.
- Most of these sauces take less time to make than the meat takes to heat. Start the sauce while the jar warms.

How to use this guide

1. Open your jar and heat the meat.
2. Find the sauce that matches your jar (see PAIRS WITH at the top of each recipe).
3. Make the sauce while the meat heats.
4. Serve. Dinner in under 20 minutes.

The 10 Sauces

01 **Smoky Chipotle Crema** — *Tacos, Barbacoa, Carnitas*
02 **Classic Brown Gravy** — *Beef Roast, Shredded Beef, Venison*
03 **Lemon Herb Butter Sauce** — *Chicken, Rabbit, Salmon*
04 **Tuscan White Wine Sauce** — *Tuscan Chicken, Wild Boar*
05 **Quick Mole Sauce** — *Barbacoa, Pulled Pork, Chipotle Chicken*
06 **Apple Cider Mustard Sauce** — *Carnitas, Honey Garlic Pork, Sausage*
07 **Creamy Mushroom Stroganoff Sauce** — *Stroganoff Base, Shredded Beef, Venison*
08 **Spicy Chimichurri** — *Corned Beef, Brisket, Wild Boar*
09 **Asian Ginger Glaze** — *Pulled Pork, Honey Garlic Pork, Cuban Mojo Pork*
10 **Classic BBQ Finishing Sauce** — *Pulled Pork, Brisket, BBQ Chicken*

SAUCE 01

Smoky Chipotle Crema

PAIRS WITH:
Beef Taco Filling (Ch.5) · Beef Barbacoa (Ch.5) · Pork Carnitas (Ch.6) · Spicy Chipotle Chicken (Ch.7)

This is the sauce that turns a jar of taco filling into a restaurant-quality dinner. Smoky, slightly spicy, and creamy — it takes 10 minutes and no cooking. The chipotle does all the work.

Time	Difficulty	Yield	Best for
10 min	**Beginner**	**1 cup / 240 ml**	**Tacos · Rice bowls · Wraps**

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup sour cream (store-bought or homemade)
- 1–2 chipotle peppers in adobo sauce, finely minced (start with 1 for mild)
- 1 tsp adobo sauce from the can
- 1 tbsp fresh lime juice
- 1 clove garlic, finely minced or grated
- ½ tsp ground cumin
- ¼ tsp salt
- 2 tbsp fresh cilantro, finely chopped (optional)

METHOD

1. Finely mince the chipotle pepper — the smaller the pieces, the smoother the sauce.
2. In a bowl, combine sour cream, minced chipotle, adobo sauce, lime juice, garlic, cumin, and salt.
3. Stir well until fully combined.
4. Taste and adjust — add more chipotle for heat, more lime for brightness.
5. Refrigerate for at least 15 minutes before serving to let the flavors develop.
6. Store in a sealed jar in the refrigerator for up to 5 days.

Pro tip
Wear gloves when handling chipotle peppers — the adobo sauce stains. Start with 1 pepper and taste before adding more. The heat intensifies as the sauce sits.

Serving suggestion
Drizzle over taco filling in warm tortillas. Use as a dipping sauce for carnitas. Swirl into a bowl of chipotle chicken served over rice. Add a spoonful to beef stew for a smoky kick.

SAUCE 02

Classic Brown Gravy

PAIRS WITH:
Slow-Cooked Beef Roast Base (Ch.9) · Simple Shredded Beef (Ch.5) · Venison Stew Base with Carrot and Onion (Ch.8) · Turkey in Herb Broth (Ch.7)

The broth inside your canned meat jars is liquid gold — this gravy uses it as the base. No need for store-bought. Rich, savory, and ready in 15 minutes. This is the sauce that makes a jar of shredded beef feel like a Sunday roast.

Time	Difficulty	Yield	Best for
15 min	**Beginner**	**2 cups / 480 ml**	**Roast-style dinners · Mash**

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups broth from your canned meat jar (beef, venison, or turkey — whatever matches the meat)
- 2 tbsp unsalted butter
- 2 tbsp all-purpose flour
- 1 small shallot or ½ small onion, very finely diced
- 1 tsp Worcestershire sauce
- ½ tsp garlic powder
- Salt and black pepper to taste
- Fresh thyme or rosemary (optional, for finishing)

METHOD

1. In a small saucepan, melt butter over medium heat. Add the shallot and cook until soft — about 3 minutes.
2. Add flour and stir constantly for 1–2 minutes until the mixture turns light golden and smells nutty. This is the roux.
3. Slowly pour in the broth, whisking constantly to avoid lumps. Add a little at a time at first.
4. Add Worcestershire sauce and garlic powder. Stir well.
5. Bring to a gentle simmer and cook for 5–8 minutes, stirring frequently, until the gravy thickens.
6. Season with salt and pepper. Add fresh herbs if using.
7. Serve immediately or keep warm over very low heat.

Pro tip
The secret to lump-free gravy is adding warm or room-temperature broth to the hot roux slowly while whisking. Never pour it all in at once. If lumps appear, strain through a fine sieve.

Serving suggestion
Pour over sliced beef roast served with mashed potatoes. Use as a base for a quick cottage pie by topping with mash and baking 20 minutes. Serve alongside venison with roasted root vegetables.

SAUCE 03

Lemon Herb Butter Sauce

PAIRS WITH:
Classic Canned Chicken Breast in Broth (Ch.7) · Lemon Herb Chicken (Ch.7) · Rabbit in Herb Broth (Ch.8) · Home-Canned Salmon with Dill (Ch.8)

Light, bright, and elegant. This sauce takes 10 minutes and transforms the mildest proteins — chicken, rabbit, salmon — into something that feels intentional and refined. The acid from the lemon cuts through the richness of the butter perfectly.

Time	Difficulty	Yield	Best for
10 min	**Beginner**	**½ cup / 120 ml**	**Elegant dinners · Fish · Rabbit**

INGREDIENTS

- 4 tbsp unsalted butter, cold, cut into small cubes
- 2 cloves garlic, finely minced
- 3 tbsp fresh lemon juice (about 1 large lemon)
- 1 tsp lemon zest
- 2 tbsp fresh parsley, finely chopped
- 1 tsp fresh thyme leaves (or ½ tsp dried)
- Salt and white pepper to taste
- 2 tbsp chicken broth from the jar (optional, for extra depth)

METHOD

1. In a small saucepan, melt 1 tbsp of butter over medium-low heat.
2. Add garlic and cook gently for 1 minute — do not let it brown.
3. Add lemon juice and broth if using. Bring to a light simmer.
4. Remove from heat and add remaining cold butter cubes one at a time, swirling the pan constantly until each piece melts into the sauce.
5. Stir in lemon zest, parsley, and thyme.
6. Season with salt and white pepper.
7. Serve immediately — this sauce does not reheat well.

Pro tip
Adding cold butter off the heat (a technique called 'mounting') creates a glossy, emulsified sauce rather than a greasy one. Keep the heat low and work quickly. If the sauce breaks (looks oily), add a splash of cold water and whisk.

Serving suggestion
Spoon over heated chicken breast served with steamed asparagus or green beans. Drizzle over salmon with a side of boiled new potatoes. Finish rabbit with this sauce and serve over soft polenta.

SAUCE 04

Tuscan White Wine Sauce

PAIRS WITH:
Tuscan Garlic Chicken (Ch.7) · Chicken Cacciatore Base (Ch.9) · Lemon Herb Chicken (Ch.7) · Rabbit in Herb Broth (Ch.8)

Sun-dried tomatoes, garlic, and a splash of white wine — this sauce brings the Italian countryside to your dinner table in 20 minutes. It pairs naturally with the Tuscan-seasoned recipes in the book and elevates wild boar or rabbit into something dinner-party worthy.

Time	Difficulty	Yield	Best for
20 min	**Beginner Plus**	**1½ cups / 360 ml**	**Pasta nights · Italian-style**

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 3 cloves garlic, thinly sliced
- ¼ cup sun-dried tomatoes, drained and roughly chopped
- ½ cup dry white wine (Pinot Grigio or Sauvignon Blanc)
- 1 cup chicken broth from the jar
- ½ cup heavy cream
- 1 tsp dried Italian seasoning
- ½ tsp red pepper flakes
- 2 tbsp fresh basil, torn
- Salt and black pepper to taste
- 2 tbsp Parmesan, grated (to finish)

METHOD

1. Heat olive oil in a wide pan over medium heat. Add sliced garlic and cook until golden — about 2 minutes. Watch carefully, it burns fast.
2. Add sun-dried tomatoes and stir for 1 minute.
3. Pour in white wine and let it bubble for 2–3 minutes until reduced by half. Add wine only when making the sauce, after opening the jar — never before canning.
4. Add broth, Italian seasoning, and red pepper flakes. Simmer for 5 minutes.
5. Stir in heavy cream and simmer for another 5 minutes until slightly thickened.
6. Remove from heat. Add fresh basil and Parmesan. Stir well.
7. Season with salt and pepper. Serve immediately.

Pro tip
Use a dry white wine you would actually drink — the alcohol cooks off but the flavor stays. If you prefer to skip alcohol, substitute with an equal amount of chicken broth and 1 tsp of white wine vinegar.

Serving suggestion
Pour over Tuscan chicken served on a bed of pasta or crusty bread to soak up the sauce. Use with wild boar over creamy polenta. Add a handful of baby spinach to the sauce at the end for a complete one-pan dinner.

SAUCE 05

Quick Mole Sauce

PAIRS WITH:
Beef Barbacoa (Ch.5) · Classic Pulled Pork (Ch.6) · Spicy Chipotle Chicken (Ch.7) · Ground Venison Chili Base (Ch.8)

Real mole takes hours. This version takes 25 minutes and delivers the essential flavor profile: dark, complex, slightly smoky, with a hint of chocolate that surprises everyone who tries it. It sounds unusual — it tastes extraordinary. Perfect over the rich, deeply seasoned meats in this book.

Time	Difficulty	Yield	Best for
25 min	**Beginner Plus**	**2 cups / 480 ml**	**Mexican nights · Enchiladas**

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil or neutral oil
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 tbsp chili powder
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- ½ tsp smoked paprika
- ¼ tsp cinnamon
- 1 can (14 oz) crushed tomatoes
- 1 cup beef broth from the jar
- 1 oz dark chocolate (70% cocoa or higher), roughly chopped
- 1 tbsp peanut butter
- 1 tsp apple cider vinegar
- Salt to taste

METHOD

1. Heat oil in a saucepan over medium heat. Add onion and cook for 5 minutes until soft.
2. Add garlic and cook for 1 minute more.
3. Add chili powder, cumin, smoked paprika, and cinnamon. Stir constantly for 1 minute to toast the spices.
4. Add crushed tomatoes and broth. Stir well and bring to a simmer.
5. Cook uncovered for 10 minutes, stirring occasionally.
6. Remove from heat. Add chocolate, peanut butter, and vinegar. Stir until chocolate melts completely.
7. Blend until smooth using an immersion blender or transfer carefully to a regular blender.
8. Return to heat for 2 minutes. Season with salt.

Pro tip
The chocolate is not optional — it is what makes this a mole rather than a chili sauce. Use the darkest chocolate you have. The peanut butter adds body and a subtle richness. Both dissolve completely into the sauce.

Serving suggestion

Serve barbacoa smothered in mole with warm corn tortillas and pickled red onion. Pour over pulled pork and serve with rice and black beans. Use as a base for enchiladas filled with chipotle chicken.

SAUCE 06

Apple Cider Mustard Sauce

PAIRS WITH:
Pork Carnitas (Ch.6) · Honey Garlic Pork Loin (Ch.6) · Sausage in Herb Broth (Ch.6) · Turkey in Herb Broth (Ch.7)

Tangy, slightly sweet, with a mustard backbone that cuts through the richness of pork perfectly. This sauce is the reason a simple jar of carnitas becomes a dinner worth remembering. It also works beautifully with turkey — the apple notes complement the herb broth naturally.

Time	Difficulty	Yield	Best for
15 min	**Beginner**	**1 cup / 240 ml**	**Pork dinners · Sunday roast**

INGREDIENTS

- 1 tbsp unsalted butter
- 1 small shallot, finely minced
- ½ cup apple cider (not vinegar — the juice)
- 2 tbsp apple cider vinegar
- 2 tbsp Dijon mustard
- 1 tsp whole grain mustard
- ½ cup heavy cream or pork broth from the jar
- 1 tsp honey
- Fresh thyme (2 sprigs or ½ tsp dried)
- Salt and black pepper to taste

METHOD

1. Melt butter in a small saucepan over medium heat. Add shallot and cook for 3 minutes until soft.
2. Add apple cider and cider vinegar. Bring to a simmer and cook until reduced by half — about 4 minutes.
3. Whisk in both mustards and honey. Stir well.
4. Add cream or pork broth and thyme. Simmer for 5 minutes until slightly thickened.
5. Remove thyme sprigs if using fresh.
6. Season with salt and pepper.
7. Serve warm.

Pro tip
Apple cider (the juice) gives sweetness and fruit flavor. Apple cider vinegar gives acidity. You need both — they do different jobs. If you only have one, use the vinegar and add ½ tsp of honey to compensate for the missing sweetness.

Serving suggestion
Spoon over carnitas served with roasted apple slices and mashed root vegetables. Drizzle over sliced honey garlic pork with sautéed kale. Serve alongside sausage with creamy mashed potatoes and braised cabbage.

SAUCE 07

Creamy Mushroom Stroganoff Sauce

PAIRS WITH:
Savory Beef Stroganoff Base (Ch.5) · Simple Shredded Beef (Ch.5) · Slow-Cooked Beef Roast Base (Ch.9) · Venison Stew Base with Carrot and Onion (Ch.8)

The Stroganoff Base in Chapter 5 is designed to be finished with this sauce. But it works just as well with any shredded beef or venison jar — turning a simple protein into a full, creamy, deeply satisfying dinner in under 20 minutes.

Time	Difficulty	Yield	Best for
20 min	**Beginner Plus**	**2 cups / 480 ml**	**Pasta nights · Comfort food**

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp unsalted butter
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 300g (10 oz) cremini or button mushrooms, sliced
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- ½ cup beef broth from the jar
- 1 tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- ¾ cup sour cream
- Salt and black pepper to taste
- Fresh parsley to finish

METHOD

1. Melt butter in a wide pan over medium-high heat. Add onion and cook for 4 minutes until starting to soften.
2. Add garlic and mushrooms. Cook without stirring for 2–3 minutes to let mushrooms brown.
3. Stir and continue cooking until mushrooms have released their liquid and it has evaporated — about 5 minutes total.
4. Add smoked paprika and stir for 30 seconds.
5. Add broth and Worcestershire sauce. Stir and scrape any browned bits from the pan.
6. Simmer for 3 minutes. Remove from heat.
7. Stir in Dijon mustard and sour cream. Do not boil after adding sour cream — it will curdle.
8. Season with salt and pepper. Garnish with parsley.

Pro tip
Sour cream curdles if boiled — always add it off the heat or over very low heat and do not let the sauce simmer again after adding it. If it does curdle, it is still safe to eat, just visually less appealing.

Serving suggestion

Stir heated Stroganoff Base directly into this sauce and serve over egg noodles or mashed potatoes. Use with shredded beef over wide pasta ribbons. Serve venison stroganoff over creamy polenta for a more refined presentation.

SAUCE 08

Spicy Chimichurri

PAIRS WITH:
Classic Corned Beef (Ch.5) · Beef Brisket with BBQ Flavors (Ch.5) · Wild Boar in Red Wine Broth Base (Ch.8) · Simple Venison in Broth (Ch.8)

No cooking required. This Argentinian sauce is the fastest way to add a bright, herby, punchy flavor to any canned beef or game meat. It cuts through richness, adds freshness, and makes everything taste like it was made minutes ago rather than months ago.

Time	Difficulty	Yield	Best for
10 min	**Beginner**	**1 cup / 240 ml**	**BBQ nights · Steak-style dinners**

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup fresh flat-leaf parsley, tightly packed, finely chopped
- 3 cloves garlic, finely minced
- 1 small red chili or ½ tsp red pepper flakes (adjust to heat preference)
- 2 tbsp fresh oregano leaves (or 1 tsp dried)
- ½ cup good quality olive oil
- 3 tbsp red wine vinegar
- 1 tbsp fresh lemon juice
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper

METHOD

1. Finely chop the parsley by hand — do not use a food processor or it becomes mushy.
2. Combine parsley, garlic, chili, and oregano in a bowl.
3. Add olive oil, red wine vinegar, and lemon juice. Stir well.
4. Season with salt and pepper.
5. Let the chimichurri rest for at least 15 minutes before serving — the flavors bloom significantly.
6. Store in a sealed jar in the refrigerator for up to 1 week. Bring to room temperature before serving.

Pro tip
The quality of the olive oil matters here more than in most recipes — it is raw and front and center. Use the best you have. Flat-leaf (Italian) parsley has more flavor than curly parsley. Chop by hand for the best texture.

Serving suggestion
Spoon generously over sliced corned beef with boiled potatoes and carrots. Use as a finishing sauce for sliced brisket. Serve alongside venison or wild boar with crusty bread to soak up the sauce.

SAUCE 09

Asian Ginger Glaze

PAIRS WITH:
Smoky Pulled Pork Base (Ch.9) · Classic Pulled Pork (Ch.6) · Honey Garlic Pork Loin (Ch.6) · Spicy Cuban Mojo Pork (Ch.6)

Sweet, savory, with a warming ginger kick — this glaze adds an unexpected dimension to any pork jar. It takes 12 minutes and transforms the flavor profile completely. The Asian-inspired profile works especially well with the Cuban and smoky seasoning already built into your pork jars.

Time	Difficulty	Yield	Best for
12 min	**Beginner**	**¾ cup / 180 ml**	**Asian-style bowls · Bao buns**

INGREDIENTS

- 3 tbsp soy sauce
- 2 tbsp honey
- 1 tbsp rice vinegar (or apple cider vinegar)
- 1 tbsp sesame oil
- 2 tsp fresh ginger, finely grated (not dried)
- 2 cloves garlic, finely minced
- 1 tsp cornstarch mixed with 2 tbsp cold water
- ½ tsp red pepper flakes (optional)
- 1 tbsp sesame seeds and sliced green onion to finish

METHOD

1. In a small saucepan, combine soy sauce, honey, rice vinegar, and sesame oil. Whisk together.
2. Add ginger and garlic. Bring to a gentle simmer over medium heat.
3. Cook for 3 minutes, stirring occasionally.
4. Add the cornstarch slurry (cornstarch + water) and stir immediately.
5. Cook for 2 more minutes until the glaze thickens and coats the back of a spoon.
6. Remove from heat. Add red pepper flakes if using.
7. Serve warm, garnished with sesame seeds and green onion.

Pro tip
Fresh ginger is essential here — dried ginger has a completely different flavor and will not give the same brightness. Use a microplane or the fine side of a box grater. Peel the ginger first with the back of a spoon.

Serving suggestion
Toss heated pulled pork in the glaze and serve in steamed bao buns or over rice with pickled cucumber. Drizzle over Cuban mojo pork with black beans and rice for an Asian-Cuban fusion bowl. Use as a dipping sauce alongside honey garlic pork with stir-fried vegetables.

SAUCE 10

Classic BBQ Finishing Sauce

PAIRS WITH:
Smoky Pulled Pork Base (Ch.9) · Beef Brisket with BBQ Flavors (Ch.5) · Smoky BBQ Pulled Chicken (Ch.7) · Smoky BBQ Pork Base (Ch.6)

This is not the BBQ sauce you put on before cooking. This is the sauce you add at the table — brighter, more acidic, with a fresher flavor than anything that comes from a bottle. Made in 20 minutes and calibrated to complement the smoky seasoning already built into your canned meats.

Time	Difficulty	Yield	Best for
20 min	**Beginner**	**2 cups / 480 ml**	**BBQ nights · Sandwiches**

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup ketchup
- 3 tbsp apple cider vinegar
- 2 tbsp brown sugar
- 1 tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- ½ tsp onion powder
- ½ tsp ground mustard
- ¼ tsp cayenne pepper (adjust to taste)
- 2 tbsp broth from your canned pork or beef jar
- Salt and black pepper to taste

METHOD

1. Combine all ingredients in a small saucepan. Whisk well to combine.
2. Bring to a gentle simmer over medium heat, stirring occasionally.
3. Reduce heat to low and simmer for 15 minutes, stirring regularly, until the sauce thickens slightly.
4. Taste and adjust: more vinegar for brightness, more sugar for sweetness, more cayenne for heat.
5. Remove from heat and let cool for 5 minutes before serving.
6. Store in a sealed jar in the refrigerator for up to 2 weeks.

Pro tip
Adding 2 tablespoons of your canning broth ties the sauce flavor to the specific meat you are serving — a small detail that makes a real difference. The broth is already seasoned and adds depth without extra salt.

Serving suggestion
Toss heated pulled pork in the sauce and pile onto brioche buns with coleslaw. Brush over sliced brisket and serve with corn on the cob and potato salad. Use as a dipping sauce for BBQ chicken served with mac and cheese.

You now have everything you need.

A pantry full of shelf-stable meat. Ten sauces to make it extraordinary. And the knowledge to do it all safely.

Want more resources?

Download the free Canning Checklist Pack — Equipment List + Step-by-Step Process